

NEWS

ROUNDUP

PROFESSOR BABATUNDE BAKARE REWARDED FOR A PROPOSAL SUBMITTED

A call for proposals in 2019 for a jointly funded programme by the South Africa Department of Higher Education and the British Council titled “University Staff Doctoral Programme landed Professor Babatunde Bakare the opportunity of a lifetime. Together with his research peers from Manchester Metropolitan University (UK) and the University of Johannesburg (UJ), they developed a proposal with the theme “Sustainable societies and disruptive technology”. The collaborative proposal seeks to develop capacity through supporting ten University staff for doctoral studies in-line with the project theme.

“The purpose of this collaborative project is to promote multi- and inter-disciplinary cross-pollination across broad areas of research to increase the chances of community-focused research interventions. The

programme supports six MUT and four UJ staff members through a bursary stipend for research purposes, specialised staff development training that will take place in the United Kingdom and South Africa, and co-supervision support by academics at MMU, and also promoting internationalization”, said Professor Bakare. A collaborative agreement has already been signed by all three Universities involved.

In July this year he led a delegation comprising of the MUT doctoral cohort as part of strengthening MUT’s internationalisation strategy. The travel was an all-paid expense by the South Africa Department of Higher Education and the British Council. “The team came back more reinvigorated and we should expect a prefix in their names soon”, said a jovial Bakare.

DR MABONGI YVONNE MVUYANE JOINS THE US-AFRICA COLLABORATION FORUM

Watch out for the Acting Head of Department of Public Management Dr MaBongi Mvuyane as she rocks the internationalisation trajectory

at MUT. She has recently been invited to be part of the US-Africa Collaboration forum. It is a forum with members from SA, Africa and international countries

including universities and NGOs. The group normally meets once a month to discuss issues on housing poor communities, activities of the Institute of Human Settlement Practitioners in SA, type of support to be given to students, Human Settlements Symposium and professional exchange between US and SA in 2023. She

has also been introduced to the Global Classroom which is a partnership between an international university and NMU. In the Global Classroom lectures are conducted for students on various human settlements topics. The last lecture attended was facilitated by the Nelson Mandela University Human Settlements Department.

A RESEARCH COLLABORATION THAT KEEPS ON GROWING

Professor Sandiso Ngcobo, the Communications Head of Department has a collaboration with a colleague from the University of Lesotho that has been in place since 2016. “We work on a registered project on multilingualism development across the two countries. This has seen us co-publishing articles since 2018 and it is ongoing. We have presented some of our work at DUT in 2016 and in Russia in February 2019 using funding from our respective organisations. However, our work and planned future endeavours do not receive outside funding. Although there is no formalised collaboration between universities, both researchers have continued to present papers every year since 2018:

- Ngcobo S & Makumane MA (2022 under review) The linguistic reconstruction of African nations: a case of post-colonial South Africa and Lesotho. *Literator journal*
- Ngcobo S & Makumane MA (2022 in press) *Lecturers’ beliefs and behaviour towards multilingual*

curriculum teaching material. *African identities journal*

- Makumane MA & Ngcobo S. (2020). The representation of curricular spider-web model in the Lesotho curriculum and assessment policy framework.
- Journal of Transdisciplinary Research Southern Africa.;17(1), a796.
<https://doi.org/10.4102/td.v17i1.796>
- Ngcobo, S. & Makumane, M. 2019. Pre-service teachers’ attitudes towards the teaching of Mandarin in South Africa,
- Perspectives in Education, 37(3): 1-14 DOI: <http://dx.doi.org/10.18820/2519593X/pie>
- Makumane, M & Ngcobo, S. (2018). The socio-economic value of French: The learners’ voice. *South African Journal of African Languages*, 38(2): 56-69.

KUDOS TO DR MANTWA MADIBA

Dr Mantwa Madiba obtained her PhD in law from the Wake Forest University, USA, in May 2022, through a Fulbright scholarship for doctoral studies. She is back in SA and goes on to explain her journey saying “This was a very challenging journey. However, I learned a great deal and gained invaluable experience. I also seized opportunities to promote MUT, mentioning our institution during my doctoral oral examination and other informal occasions. I hope this contributed to expanding MUT’s footprint”, she said.

“I am happy to be back and my favourite aspect of returning home is having access to the world’s best food and having more family nearby. It was not easy but with the love and support from my family and friends in the United States and South Africa, I persevered and achieved my dream”, she added.



Dr Mantwa Madiba

INTERNATIONAL SPORTS NEWS

MUT SPORT DEPUTY DIRECTOR ELECTED TO CONTINENTAL SPORTING BOARD

The MUT Deputy Director of Sport, Siyabulela Mkwalo, has been elected to the African Boxing Confederation (AFBC) Board of Directors.

This board is the highest controlling body in the continent, empowered to regulate boxing affairs in Africa. Mkwalo, who is also the President of the South African National Boxing Organisation (SANABO), said the organisation “has never had a representative in the AFBC. The election of a South African representative into the continental board will facilitate the development of boxing in the country. South Africa is now well positioned to influence the future direction of boxing through improving the governing rules to suit its needs.”

He also said the new development presented an opportunity for South Africa to network with other members of the Board, “and form partnerships with many African countries, and those beyond the borders of our continent”. He added that it was through such partnerships that South Africa would be able to improve its capacity for coaching and officiating.



According to Mkwalo, partnerships would be formalised with many countries for exchange programmes that would give birth to international friendly competitions and training camps. He said such an arrangement would add value to the quality of boxers that will represent the country during major international competitions. These include, but are not limited to, Zonal Championships, African Championships, Commonwealth Games, Olympic Games, and World Championships.

Mkwalo said that serving at a continental level presents a myriad of personal growth opportunities based on the calibre of board members within the same committee. His involvement in the board presents an avenue to

learn more about exemplary international governance practices that would empower and sharpen his skills. It is the very same skills that will be leveraged to benefit MUT for its boxing development.

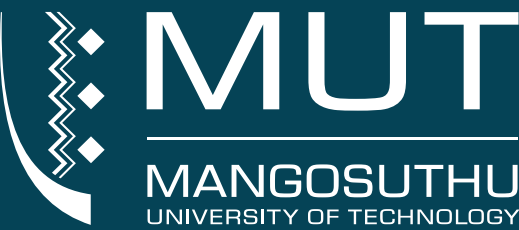
MUT COMBAT SPORT TEAM IN TURKEY

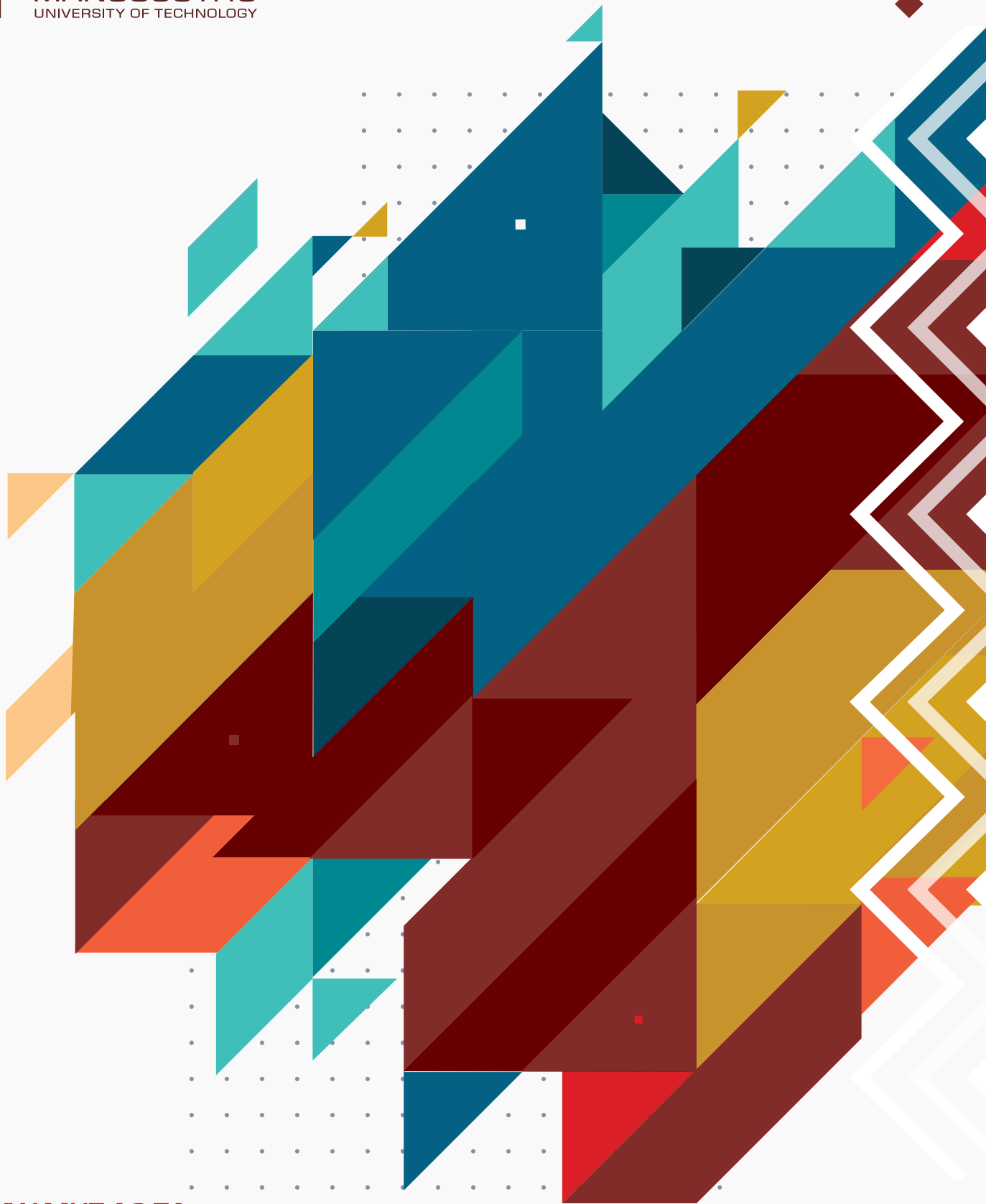
Bongile Ganyile, MUT Sports officer led a team that participated at the Federation Internationale du Sport Universitaire (FISU). These are world university games and the MUT team participated in combat sport with team Ganyile as the team manager. Well done to Ganyile and Nosipho Nyembe, the assistant coach for elevating brand MUT in the national sporting stages.



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